



Referee Report

The applicant has named you as a referee in support of an application for an Australia Awards Scholarship supported by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFAT) for study in Australia. To assist in the selection process, we would like to receive your views on the applicant's suitability for a Scholarship, in particular on their capabilities and personal qualities, academic competence (including, where applicable, their research ability) and potential outcomes.

1. Personal Details

Personal details	Applicant response
Applicant's details	Applicant Answers
Full name (as it appears in passport)	Antonio Lestimasi Moeaki
Email	al.moeaki@gmail.com
Area of research interest	Economics / Statistics
Referee's details	Referee Answers
Family name	VELASQUEZ HURTADO
Given names	Camilo
Mobile no.	0404 520 305
Work no.	0404 520 305
Email	cvelasquezhurtado@gmail.com
Name	Queensland University of Technology
Town/City, Country	Brisbane
Position title	Student
Starting date	01/ 02/ 2021
Length of time you have known applicant	☐ Less than 3 months ☐ 3–12 months ☐ 1–2 years ☒ 2–5 years ☐ More than 5 years



Personal details	Applicant response
Relationship to applicant (e.g. direct supervisor, lecturer, peer, etc)	Peer, friend and group member in three different group projects.
Authorised official stamp of the organisation.	I'm not a student there anymore but I can send a copy of my degree If you want proof

2. Evaluation of applicant's capabilities and behaviours

Please evaluate the applicant against the following criteria*

Criteria	Very good	Satisfactory	Needs coaching	Not observed
Shapes strategic thinking (meaning that they: inspire a sense of purpose and direction; focus strategically; harness information and opportunities; and show judgement, intelligence and commonsense)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Achieves results (meaning that they: build organisation capability and responsiveness; marshal professional expertise; steer and implement change and deal with uncertainty; ensure closure and deliver on intended results)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Cultivates productive working relationships (meaning that they: nurture internal and external relationships; facilitate cooperation and partnerships; value individual differences and diversity; and guide, mentor and develop people)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Displays personal drive and integrity (meaning that they: demonstrate professionalism and probity; commit to action; display resilience; promote and adopt a positive and balanced approach to work; and demonstrate self-awareness and a commitment to personal development)	☒	☐	☐	☐
Communicates and negotiates effectively (meaning that they: communicate clearly; listen, understand and adapts to audience; and negotiates persuasively)	☒	☐	☐	☐

* Extract from the Australian Public Service Commission's 'The integrated leadership system – support tools – Leadership pathway: Individual profiles'



3. General Comments

Why should the applicant be considered for a Scholarship?

To briefly introduce my relationship with Antonio: my name is Camilo Velasquez Hurtado, and I work for the Queensland Police Service. I studied mathematics alongside Antonio at the Queensland University of Technology, where we completed three group projects together and ultimately graduated as part of the same cohort. I have known him since the beginning of 2024.

Based on the criteria above, Antonio Lestimasi Moeaki would be an excellent recipient of an Australia Awards Scholarship. Their capabilities, personal qualities, academic competence and potential outcomes are what Australia needs and here is why:

1. Shapes strategic thinking

Throughout the time I've known Antonio, he has inspired in me a sense of purpose and direction. He is a man who knows exactly where he stands and where he wants to go in life. Antonio consistently focuses on what matters most to achieve his goals, and his example has encouraged me to do the same. His ability to never waste an opportunity to learn from his teachers, peers, and surroundings is remarkable, and it has taught me to look both inward and outward for lessons I might otherwise miss. Whether his gift for finding knowledge comes from intelligence or common sense is anyone's guess, but one thing is certain, it is undeniably a part of who he is.

2. Achieves results

Across three technically demanding university projects in statistical analysis, Antonio consistently demonstrated an outstanding ability to build organisational capability and responsiveness. He naturally stepped into a facilitative role, setting up communication channels, coordinating meetings, and creating an environment where every team member could contribute meaningfully. He knew how to marshal professional expertise, both by sharing his own deep understanding of complex statistical models and by actively seeking out the specialised knowledge of others when a particular aspect of the project called for it. When we needed to steer and implement change, whether adapting our analytical approach mid project or tailoring presentations for diverse and non-technical audiences, Antonio guided those shifts with clarity and composure. He was equally steady in the face of uncertainty, handling unexpected questions and curveballs during presentations without losing focus. And crucially, Antonio always ensured closure and delivered on intended results. Despite the difficulty of the work, every project we shared felt manageable and was completed to a high standard because of his reliability, his follow-through, and his quiet determination to see things across the finish line.

3. Cultivates productive working relationships

Antonio was a great friend, and I feel honoured that he asked me to be his reference. The three projects I did with him were the easiest I ever had, even though they were the most technically demanding. That was because Antonio is an exceptional facilitator of cooperation and partnership—he was always the one to start the group chat, organise meetings, and help others whenever they asked. He genuinely valued individual differences and diversity, taking the time to get to know our team. He would assist any of us in areas where he had stronger technical insight, and he didn't hesitate to seek help from group members who understood a particular aspect of the project especially well. Antonio was an integral part of my development as a person, learner and Statistician.

4. Displays personal drive and integrity



Antonio was always a true professional and, in many ways, the de facto leader of any group project. He stood out as the most reliable person I met at university. He always following through on his commitments to both the group and individuals, communicating openly when he needed help, dedicating himself to personal growth, and willingly sacrificing his time to support others. He managed all of this without overcommitting, handling stress with composure and demonstrating self-awareness for when he needed to slow down.

5. Communicates and negotiates effectively

Antonio's communication skills are versatile, clear, and remarkably adaptable. He is one of the main reasons I loved earning my degree. Although we were peers, he was an outstanding teacher. His ability to explain complex mathematical concepts to me (someone with the same degree) and deepen my understanding, demonstrated his rare capacity to listen carefully, truly understand, and adapt his approach to the individual.

When it came to larger audiences, Antonio and I worked together on three full-semester group projects that required presenting to people from diverse backgrounds. That meant communicating complex mathematical models in a way that non-specialists could grasp. In those presentations, Antonio was always the knowledgeable anchor who could field any curveball with composure.

4. Referees Declaration and Signature

I declare that the information in this report is true and correct.

Signature: **Camilo Hurtado Velasquez**

Date 19/ 04 / 2 0 2 6

Thank you for assisting the Australian Government in identifying an outstanding candidate for an Australia Awards Scholarship.

